

DCU Research Ethics Committee Participant Information Sheet

Introductory Statement

This study is led by Dr Damien Dupré, Dublin City University Business School in collaboration with Dr. Breda McNally, from DCU Institute of Education. It aims to understand the effects of international education in business degrees on career quality and salary trajectories, using a mixed methods design. The study is funded by the International Partnership of Business Schools and by Dublin City University Business School.

What is this research about?

More precisely, we are examining whether specific international elements of undergraduate business degrees, such as double degree structures and internships abroad, are linked with career outcomes including progression, pay, job satisfaction, and international mobility in the first five to seven years after graduation.

Why is this research being conducted?

Partner schools report uneven demand for double degree pathways and want stronger evidence on value. The study will provide an objective and transparent assessment to inform programme design and student information.

Why have you been invited to take part?

You completed an undergraduate business degree with an international component, so you have relevant early career experience to share. Your decision to take part or not will have no effect on any relationship with DCU or partner institutions.

What will happen if you decide to take part in this research study?

You may complete an online survey that takes about 15 minutes. You may also volunteer to a one to one follow-up interview of up to 60 minutes online by sending an email to damien.dupre@dcu.ie.

How will your data be used?

Dublin City University is the Data Controller. Some DCU approved service providers will act as Data Processors for secure survey delivery, data storage, and analysis under contract to DCU. The DCU Data Protection Officer is Mr Martin Ward, data.protection@dcu.ie. We will process your data to conduct the research described above, to analyse results, to write up findings for reports, academic publications and presentations, and to meet audit and research integrity duties.

The personal data we may process include your survey responses and basic background information such as graduation year, programme, and broad job history. No Identifiers are kept from the survey data. We will not share identifiable data outside the research team. DCU approved processors may handle data only to provide their contracted services, and they may not use it for any other purpose. Data will be stored on secure DCU systems hosted in the European Economic Area.

Retention periods are as follows. Recruitment lists for non participants are deleted 30 days after the recruitment window closes. Consent forms and any documents linking identities to participation are kept for 7 years after study close out. Anonymised survey data are retained for 10 years after publication. Anonymised outputs, instruments, and analysis code may be archived for the scholarly record.

You have rights of access, rectification, restriction, objection, and erasure where applicable. To exercise these rights, contact the research team or the DCU Data Protection Unit. You also have the right to lodge a complaint with the Data Protection Commission. If we seek any future use of identifiable data, we will ask for fresh consent. Anonymised data may be used in future research because individuals cannot be identified.

DCU Research Ethics Committee Participant Information Sheet

How will your privacy be protected (including any legal limits to confidentiality)?

We use secure systems, encrypted storage, least privilege access, and a separation of identifiers from research data. Publications will not name you or include details that are likely to identify you.

What are the benefits of taking part in this research study?

There may be no direct personal benefit. Many participants value the chance to reflect on their early career and to influence how international programmes are designed and explained to future students.

What are the risks of taking part in this study?

Risks are minimal. Some questions about work or pay may feel personal. You can skip any question or stop at any time.

Can you change your mind at any stage and withdraw from this study?

Participation is voluntary. You can withdraw at any time without giving a reason until the form is submitted. Once submitted, your anonymized data will be saved on the dedicated server and will not be identifiable.

How will you find out what happens with this project?

If you wish, we will email you a short summary of findings when the project finishes. The full report will be made publicly available after delivery to the funder. Academic publications and presentations will follow.

Contact details for further information:

Dr Damien Dupré, Dublin City University Business School, damien.dupre@dcu.ie

If participants have concerns about this study and wish to contact an independent person, please contact:

The Secretary, Dublin City University Research Ethics Committee, c/o Research and Innovation Support, Dublin City University, Dublin 9. Tel 01-7008000, e-mail rec@dcu.ie